‘cause darling, you’re the one (and fuck, i want you)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/56847106.

Rating:
General Audiences

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
wlw, Fluff, Tooth-Rotting Fluff, Romantic Fluff, Fluff and Hurt/Comfort, Hurt/Comfort, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Emotional Hurt, Mild Hurt/Comfort, wasn’t planning for this to become a hurt/comfort but is that even avoidable with catradora, love & dating wasn't a thing in the horde, takes place shortly after S5, so she ra spoilers, Adora has a new softer and claw-proof mattress, adora brushes catras hair, catra gets the pets she deserves, adora and catra discuss their relationship

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by mewudon

Summary

“I guess we should ask Bow and Glimmer what comes after being friends.” She and Catra definitely knew the feeling, but they didn’t quite know the name. “Or what’s after best friends.”

Catra hummed in agreement. “They seem to be well-versed in that.”

Adora chuckled softly. “I wonder what they’re up to right now.” She let one of her hands selfishly cup underneath Catra’s chin and gently scratch in a massage-like manner, and Catra promptly stuck out her chin even further.

“Don’t talk about them anymore. Sparkles always has some kind of sixth sense—“ She added on in a whisper, “I don’t want her teleporting in on us right now.”

…

aka Adora gives Catra some well-deserved pets.

Notes

Chloe Moriondo lyrics for the title :3
I know so many Catradora fics take place in Adora’s bedroom (at least of the ones I’ve read) but idkk where else would Adora just have a hairbrush lying around? forgive me just this once. was originally going to be Catra lying in Adora's lap in Brightmoon's royal garden but I couldn't easily reason as to why she would have a hairbrush out there! so her room will have to do.

After a brisk walk around Brightmoon's castle, Adora couldn't keep her thoughts straight. It had been weeks since the Rebellion had risen as victorious against the Horde (it was so hard for her to wrap her head around that fact) and now, the rest of the Princess Alliance wanted to spend a little time relaxing… and celebrating, on top of providing aid to various kingdoms across Etheria. Despite this, Adora had this constant gnawing anxiety that she should be spending her time planning her next attack or working to condition her capabilities as She Ra. All her life, Adora had only known nonstop training. Nonstop action. Nonstop fighting. Nonstop apprehension, nervousness, and stress… Nonstop… She wasn't used to celebrations. Any time she would give in to them, they were always cut short due to an attack from the Horde taking advantage of her foolishness.

Adora pushed her way into her chambers and took a heavy seat at her vanity. She held onto the edges of the table and let herself take a deep breath carefully through her nose as she gazed into her reflection, feeling her shoulders relax as the influx of air left her lungs. Think rationally, Adora.

There was no reason to prepare for battle anymore. The Horde was gone. Shadow Weaver was gone… Hordak– or, his controlling, abusive motivation, was gone. Horde Prime was gone. Countless planets were saved from his grasp. Universes could finally rest. Etheria could see the stars again.

Better yet, Catra was reunited with Adora, in ways more satisfactory than Adora could have hoped for– that neither of them could have hoped for.

The war was over.

Enough sulking. If Adora was going to overthink something, she needed to overthink about helping Glimmer and the rest of the princesses propose different forms of aid to the Etherian kingdoms that suffered the most during the war– and to pretty much all of the people of Etheria. That sounded like a good plan.

Once back to her senses, Adora realized how messy her hair had gotten. Throughout being tied up in a ponytail all day, Adora's bad habit of scratching at her scalp when she felt stressed did a number on it. She ran her fingers through the loose strands before ultimately undoing the elaborate elastic twists of her hair tie. Adora wasn't yet accustomed to brushing her hair as often as almost everyone she knew kept telling her she should be.

(When Mermista discovered that Adora's haircare was lacking, she refused to let it go. She had insisted that the Princess Alliance indulge in a spa day. Returning to her room after a long day of pampering and enduring the utter shock from the other princesses over Adora's lack of self-care knowledge, Catra wouldn't let Adora live her (temporary) new look down, at least not for the night. She made sure to let Adora know that she wasn't a big fan of her shiny, curled hair, or her "glowing, angelic" complexion. And honestly, Adora couldn't tell if she was just being facetious or if she actually hated it.)

Now, Adora felt a little more inclined to keep up with taking care of her hair. It had felt so light after their spa day– she usually kept her hair out of her face for it to stay out of the way of her training, but she couldn't help but feel selfishly beautiful when she had peeked at herself in a mirror that day. Running the brush through her tangles, Adora heard the sound of light footsteps making an entrance into her bedroom. Looking at her through the mirror, she observed as Catra paid no mind to Adora as she strolled across her room– or their room, as Catra refused to sleep in her own, for reasons unbeknownst to anyone but Adora– and flopped down lazily onto the end of the excessively cushioned bed.

"...Hey, Adora," she purred.

Adora smiled fondly at her friend… Friend… Could they really still call each other that? Adora recognized they hadn't really addressed their feelings for each other since their lips touched for the first time– when Adora was close to giving up for the first, and what could have been the last time in her life. Not that either of

them were avoiding such discussion, it just never came up… and so much was still going on. “Catra… What’re you up to?”

Catra opened one eye to meet Adora’s in the mirror. “What, can a girl not just lay down around here?”

“Oh, don’t be like that. I was just asking.”

“I should be the one asking what you’re up to. Fitting into that princess role of yours?” She gestured towards the brush in Adora’s hand.

Adora shot Catra a look. “Can I not just take care of my hair for once?”

“Hey, hey, I never said it was a bad thing.” Catra rolled over onto her stomach and stretched her body out across the mattress, her tail waving slowly behind her in contentment. “It’s just that I don’t see you taking care of yourself that often...” Adora rolled her eyes with a smile before resuming her brushing. Glancing at Catra’s peaceful face, her eyes shut gently with a small grin on her lips– one of Catra’s genuine, gentle expressions that Adora missed seeing from her if she ever saw them at all.

Adora’s eyes shifted to the messy tufts of hair on top of Catra’s head. “You ever tried brushing your hair, perchance?”

Catra raised her eyebrow. “Uh, what? Brushing is for princesses who have a lot of time on their hands or whatever.”

“What does that even mean–? Whatever. So I guess not.” It made sense, really. Not Catra’s comment, but her reaction. Adora had never seen Catra ever brush her hair before. Not even growing up. The most she’d seen Catra do was lick the back of her hand and run it over the mass of strands that rested on top of her head.

“And why are you asking?”

“I guess I was wondering… y’know, if you’d let me try to brush yours.”

Catra’s expression twisted into an offended glare as she sat up straight. “What kind of question is that? Hell. No.”

“Why not, Catra? It feels good, I promise!”

“Okay, and? Why would you want little spikes poking at your head? I don’t even need to brush my hair. It looks just fine as it is.”

“It looks like a rat's nest, Catra.” It was true, kind of. Her hair had begun knotting again after growing anew. If anything, Catra looked almost akin to a stray cat with poor hygiene. “Aren’t cats supposed to like… take care of their hair?”

“I take care of it just fine,” she insisted.

Adora rolled her eyes. “Yeah, sure you do.”

“You don’t believe me?”

Adora answered her question with her head turned away in a playful pout.

“Fucking– Fine, whatever. Try brushing it if you really want to. You’ll be surprised.” Catra’s tail flicked back and forth in irritation, even more so once Adora instantly turned back to face Catra with a smile. “You’re gonna have to come to me, though. I’m not getting up.”

“You’d really let me brush your hair?” Adora asked as she sat next to Catra, the mattress sinking a little more underneath her weight, almost forcing her to sit closer to her.

“Why are you acting so surprised? Just do it before I change my mind.” Catra turned her head away from Adora, closing her eyes and furrowing her brows– a pout of uneasy anticipation and quiet submission. How cute.

Adora held up the brush in her hand and held it up to Catra's head. "Do you think a cat brush would be better? I should ask Glimmer if she has one lying around somewhere. Does Brightmoon even have any cats?"

"Adora…" Catra's head sank closer to her shoulders as her claws grasped at the mattress, seemingly becoming more impatient by the second.

"Sorry, sorry." Adora laughed to herself and finally brought the brush to Catra's scalp.

Catra hissed as Adora began brushing but didn't pull away. "Ow–! Ow…"

"I'm sorry– does it hurt?"

"No shit, Sherlock."

"That's because you don't brush your hair! It's not one big lump anymore; you should take care of it more often."

"Since when did you care so much about hair?" Catra questioned, turning her head a little towards Adora to scrutinize her out of the corner of her eye.

Adora shrugged. "Ever since the Princess Alliance decided I ought to. Besides, maybe if I keep taking better care of it, I could have hair just like She Ra!"

"You literally are She Ra."

"No, I mean– Without She Ra. As Adora." She pulled a little harder at a knot, evoking a short yowl of pain from Catra.

"Be more gentle! It feels like you're ripping my hair out of my head. I've already lost enough of it lately…"

Adora gazed down at the brush for a moment. "Well, I guess I kinda am…"

“What–?”

“No, I mean like– it just keeps coming out in clumps, but it’s coming out of nowhere– It’s like an undercoat.”

Catra gave her head a quick shake, sending tufts of fur into the air. “Maybe I like having an undercoat, did you ever think about that?? Now I’m gonna be shedding everywhere…” Catra blew a few strands of stray floating fur away from her nose.

Adora picked out the clumps of fur from in between the brush bristles. “Like you weren’t already. And really? You like having an undercoat in the middle of summer?”

Catra shrugged. “Who cares… I’m used to it.”

“I guess so,” Adora returned the gesture. They sat in silence for a moment before Adora replaced the brush with her fingers, combing gently through Catra’s hair to free up the rest of the dislodged undercoat. Adora wasn’t sure if she was surprised or not at how Catra let her shoulders sink to a degree and gently push into her touch.

Adora’s lips cracked into a smile. “You like this better than a brush, huh?”

Catra didn’t respond verbally, but Adora knew her answer after hearing a low rumble arise from her throat. The comforting sound only made Adora’s smile stretch further across her face. She really missed hearing Catra’s purr. It was such a serene feeling– a feeling of solace, of peace– especially since memories linked to it were from growing up in the Fright Zone. It was a feeling that made it seem like the only two people in the world were Catra and Adora.

She massaged the bases of Catra’s ears which were already pointed downwards in submission, no longer flicking at Adora’s touch like they used to. “Catra…”

“Adora?” She replied in a gentle voice.

Adora sat idle for a moment other than her hands working on rubbing Catra's ears. She didn't even know what she wanted to say. So many words bubbled up on the tip of her tongue all the way from the depths of her chest. "…I love you…"

Catra twitched underneath Adora's hands and lowered her head further as if to hide her face from Adora if she tried to peek. Adora began to worry if she had said something wrong— maybe the moment they shared was a heat-of-the-moment kind of thing —

A tail slunk around to touch Adora's leg and wrapped itself tentatively around it. "I— Um… I love you… too… Adora…" Catra turned her head enough to face Adora, her back still towards her. Her cheeks were a deep red that spread down her face. She broke into a tiny smile, her lips quivering in a failed attempt to stifle an inelegant laugh. "Sorry… I'm just not used to… y'know… saying… "nice" stuff," Catra met Adora's blue gaze, the former's eyes glazed with a tenderness that Adora wasn't used to seeing but was sure she wouldn't be able to get out of her head. "I mean it, though… I love you."

Adora's expression melted along with her insides, feeling all warm and fuzzy, and god her face felt hot and she felt like she could cry. However, the intensity of her emotions was short-lived as her thoughts began to confound her again. She swallowed before speaking next. "So— What does this make us…?"

Catra tilted her head.

"Like… What are… we?" Adora let one of her hands fall to Catra's arm, getting as close to her hand as she could without leaning forward too far.

Catra was quiet for a moment. "Well, it definitely makes us more than friends."

"I want to be more than friends with you," Adora declared, unable to see the stupid smile that overtook Catra's face. Her eyes

haphazardly fell onto the scarred skin below the nape of Catra's neck and felt a twinge in her heart. She brought the hand she had at Catra's ear down to the crook of her shoulder, to which Catra rested her own hand on top. Adora brushed her thumb gently over the healed tissue and let her touch serve as a subtle warning before placing her lips plaintively over the imperfection, letting her mouth linger there for an extended period when Catra didn't protest.

Adora mumbled onto her skin, "I'm sorry, Catra."

"Wh— for what?"

"For leaving you— for everything. This never should have happened to you. You didn't deserve this— It's all my fault. I'm so sorry…" Tears began to well up in both of their eyes. For Adora, they were tears of frustration and grief. For Catra, they were not only the memories that tried to push their way into her mind, but most importantly, they were for Adora.

"Just shut up…" Catra sniffed. "I mean, it doesn't matter anymore, so stop digging yourself into a hole. There was nothing you could've done differently. There's nothing you can do to change the past. You of all people should know that, Adora." She brought her hand to unknowingly rub the subtle lipstick mark Adora had left. Neither of them were used to wearing makeup yet, and Adora wasn't sure how she felt about it. But if she could leave adulatory marks over Catra's skin with nothing but the touch of her lips, maybe it was something she could get used to. "And… I forgive you… so, just stop upsetting yourself over it…"

"Catra…"

Catra turned around completely to face Adora, her hands on her knees, almost begging. "Please…"

Adora was silent, replaying Catra's words in her head like Entrapta's tape recorder. Her lashes fluttered as she blinked away her tears before they could fall— a skill she was especially good at

thanks to growing up in the Horde. Catra was being so vulnerable with her— and so honest, and open. It really made her feel special… and most of all, forgiven.

She responded in a voice unexpectedly only louder than a whisper. "Okay."

Adora brought her hands to Catra's velvety cheeks without another word, thumbing the small tufts of fluff up and down. Catra lifted her head to look at Adora, the rumble in her throat returning in full throttle as her eyes softened once more.

"I guess we should ask Bow and Glimmer what comes after being friends." She and Catra definitely knew the feeling, but they didn't quite know the name. "Or what's after best friends."

Catra hummed in agreement. "They seem to be well-versed in that."

Adora chuckled softly. "I wonder what they're up to right now." She let one of her hands selfishly cup underneath Catra's chin and gently scratch in a massage-like manner, and Catra promptly stuck out her chin even further.

"Don't talk about them anymore. Sparkles always has some kind of sixth sense—" She added on in a whisper, "I don't want her teleporting in on us right now."

"Aww, you want to be alone with me?" Adora taunted. "It's not like we're doing anything weird."

Catra's expression scrunched up into an embarrassed pout before she roughly shoved Adora down onto the mattress, gladly taking the verbal bait. Adora let out a startled yell but didn't bother to resist when Catra promptly laid down right on top of her with all of her weight, her chest resting on Adora's stomach.

"C'mon, Catra, just be frank with me," she continued her teasing. "Admit it. You like being alone with me."

Their faces were so close that Catra swore she could see all of Etheria's moons in Adora's irises. How corny. She brought her finger to Adora's forehead and gave in. "Isn't it obvious, Adora?"

There were so many words Catra wished she could have the courage to say to Adora. There was no longer any wall between them, physically or emotionally, and no worry of true judgment. But everything felt so scary, even when there wasn't a physically dangerous threat to fear. New emotions and finally feeling like—knowing that she had a place in Adora's heart. She didn't want to ruin it. And she was just too prideful. Adora would have to break her walls down every time she wanted Catra to be anything moderately close to a mushy, lovesick mess with her– to tell her genuine, sweet things. She knew what she was getting into. And Adora was more than okay with that.

"You're such a dork," Adora answered.

"Hey, you can't call me the names I call you." Catra beamed and brought her finger to wrap around a strand of Adora's hair. She let out, "At least I'm your dork," even surprising herself.

Adora's heart skipped a beat. She stuttered over her remark, "Mine…?"

Both of their faces felt hot. Catra immediately opted not to answer, changing the subject to a question she'd been wondering for a long time when her eyes fell onto Adora's chest. "Why are you still in your Horde uniform?"

Adora looked down at herself and blinked in prolonged quiet. "…I have no idea," she replied in bewilderment. "I honestly never thought about it…" She started to crack up, her chest rising and falling with pure amusement. Catra watched her before inevitably breaking into fervent laughter alongside her.

"I think it's time for a new outfit, Princess. Why don't you wear a fancy dress or something?"

Adora refused to comment. “Some new clothes would suit you well, too.”

“I guess we both need to look into an outfit change,” Catra mused, letting her hand slide to the back of Adora’s head, her fingers getting lost in her blonde strands of hair. Their legs brushed up against the other’s as they relished in the warmth of their bodies.

“I wish we could stay like this forever,” Catra admitted softly.

“Why can’t you?” Adora rested her hands on Catra’s hips, her fingers slipping tentatively beneath her shirt just to feel her skin. “There’s nothing stopping us anymore.”

Catra rested her other hand on Adora’s shoulder and gave into Adora’s daydream. “I guess not.” Lifting herself up just a little, she tilted her head and pressed her lips against Adora’s, almost as passionately as she had when the world was crumbling around them. When she was with her, nothing else mattered. She wanted to crawl inside of Adora and become one with her. She wanted to hear all of Adora’s thoughts and all of her wishes. She wanted her, and only her. All of her impurities— they were all beautiful to Catra. She wanted to be her favorite person. She wanted every little bit of Adora that Adora could possibly offer. It was intoxicating.

She loved her, she loved her, she loved her.

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